PRE-PURCHASE INSPECTION CHECKLIST

Mitsubishi Pajero / Montero (First Generation)

1982–1991 · L040 · L140 · Montero · Shogun

BOXYTRUCKS

CHECK BEFORE YOU BUY

- [ ] **Rust: windshield frame, roof and floors**
  Bring a Trailer's 1989 Raider showed corrosion on the bonnet, the windshield surround and the roof, and its 1988 Montero Sport had corrosion and failing clearcoat. Check the windshield frame, the roof gutters, the floors, the rear wheel arches and the chassis rails.
- [ ] **Steering linkage**
  Every first-generation chassis code is on Mitsubishi's pitman-arm notice. Check for play and inspect every ball-joint boot. A cracked boot means the joint needs replacing.
- [ ] **Listen for chain rattle on the 2.6**
  The 4G54 runs a timing chain and a balance-shaft chain. A rattle at cold start means a chain-and-guide job, so budget for both chains.
- [ ] **Test the hubs and 4WD**
  Engage 4H and 4L on gravel. The automatic hubs should lock and release cleanly. A truck that's been driven in 4WD on pavement may have a stressed driveline.
- [ ] **Check the paperwork and the odometer**
  Two of the BaT trucks we read about had odometer problems: a Raider with a Carfax mileage inconsistency and a Montero Sport issued 'Not Actual Mileage' titles several times. Pull a history report.
- [ ] **Know which engine and rear suspension you're getting**
  A 'V6' grille badge marks the 3.0. Leaf-sprung and coil-sprung rear ends take different parts. Any diesel in the US is a later import, so check its paperwork.
- [ ] **Run the VIN for recalls**
  US recalls include front seat-belt buckle buttons (95V103: 1986–91 Montero and 1987–89 Raider), throttle icing on 1989 trucks (89V030 for the Montero, 89V027 for the Raider) and a leaking oil-pressure sender on 1984 Monteros (84V098).
- [ ] **Budget for the small stuff**
  BaT sellers regularly list air conditioning that doesn't work, a missing headliner, and replaced fuel pumps, shocks, wheel cylinders and power-steering lines. Most are simple fixes that add up.

RECALLS TO ASK ABOUT

- [ ] **Front seat-belt buckle release buttons can break (Montero)**
  1986–1991 · NHTSA 95V103004

IS IT THE REAL THING?

- [ ] **Chassis codes**
  Mitsubishi's steering notice lists the first-generation codes: L041G, L043G, L044G, L046G, L048G, L049G, L141G, L144G, L146G and L149G.

- [ ] **Front seat-belt buckle release buttons can break (Dodge Raider)**
  1987–1989 · NHTSA 95V103003
- [ ] **Throttle valve icing (Montero)**
  1989 · NHTSA 89V030000
- [ ] **Throttle blade icing (Dodge Raider)**
  1989 · NHTSA 89V027000
- [ ] **Oil-pressure sender can leak**
  1984 · NHTSA 84V098000
- [ ] **Aftermarket Reese trailer hitch weld (equipment)**
  1987–1989 Raider · 1991 Montero · NHTSA 93E023000
- [ ] **Raider or Montero**
  The Raider is a Dodge-badged three-door only. A 'V6' grille badge marks the 3.0 V6 Raider. Mechanically it's the same as a three-door Montero.
- [ ] **Engine**
  US trucks have the 2.6 G54B SOHC four (109 hp) or the 3.0 6G72 V6 (143 hp). A diesel in the US is a later import.
- [ ] **Rear suspension**
  Leaf springs until 1988; LWB trucks then got three-link coils. BaT's 1988 Montero Sport short wheelbase still runs leaves.
- [ ] **Camel Trophy Edition**
  About 150 yellow short-wheelbase Camel Trophy Editions were built with the 4D56. Wikipedia says originals carry a yellow-and-black plaque and their own chassis code, and that replicas exist.

NOTES

From the full guide at https://boxytrucks.com/models/pajero/pajero-gen1/, with sources. Recalls follow the VIN: check at nhtsa.gov/recalls. General information only, not a professional inspection; see boxytrucks.com/about/disclaimer/. © BoxyTrucks